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ASPIRE DEVELOPMENT PLAN

Dilruba Turan

A structured growth plan covering technical upskilling, coaching, simulation & real customer work — designed to accelerate readiness as an Infrastructure Solution Engineer.

DURATION	MANAGER	COACH
March – June 2026	Leandro Lopez	Paul Verboon

Objective

Three pillars to grow into a world-class Solution Engineer

🤝 Soft Skills

- **Learn the soft skills needed to be a Solution Engineer**
- Reverse-shadowed by experienced SEs & SSPs → simulation exercises
- Shadow experienced SEs → real customer work
- Brand Building — establish presence and credibility in the field

⚙️ Hard Skills

- **Core Infrastructure & Solutions Architecture**
- Container Platforms & Cloud Native
- Modern AI Engineering Practices with GitHub Copilot

🌐 Ecosystem

- **Navigate a complex organization with confidence**
- Create a safe and empowering environment for growth
- Manager-owned: build a safe, functional ecosystem within the pod and account teams

COMPLEMENTING ASPIRE

Growth Approach

Three reinforcing tracks that accelerate Dilruba's path from Aspire foundations to field-ready SE.

On-the-Job Coaching

Learn by doing, guided by experts

- Shadow experienced SEs in real customer engagements
- Reverse-shadow sessions with feedback loops
- Weekly 1:1 coaching with dedicated coach
- Real-time guidance during live opportunities

Simulation & TestFlight

Safe space to practise and iterate

- Three simulated client sessions per run
- Realistic scenarios with panelist evaluation
- Progressive difficulty across runs
- Structured debrief and actionable feedback

Technical Upskilling

Build the skills of today and tomorrow

- Azure & infrastructure certifications
- AI, Agentic Engineering & platform thinking
- Hands-on labs and proof-of-concept builds
- Industry credentials and deep-dive workshops

Timeline

Brand Building

- Build credibility with account teams
- Become the go-to SE for your pod

Hard Skills

- AZ-305 Azure Solutions Architect Expert
- GitHub Copilot Certification
- IaC Fundamentals
- CNCF Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate

Buddy & Aspire Program

Paul
Primary Buddy & Coach

- Bi-weekly 1:1 check-ins
- Aspire cohort sessions
- On-demand pairing & guidance

TestFlight 1 — FOUNDATION

Reverse-shadowed by experienced SEs and SSPs in real-world customer simulations

1. First Client Meeting
2. Business Envisioning
3. Solution Envisioning

TestFlight 2 — CONFIDENCE

Reverse-shadowed by experienced SEs and SSPs in real-world customer simulations

1. First Client Meeting
2. Business Envisioning
3. Solution Envisioning

TestFlight Retrospective

Focus on addressing areas for improvement identified during TestFlight cycles

CONNECT

POD INFRA MILESTONES OWNER

Pulls in Sr. SEs for execution & depth

Owns milestones · Drives outcomes · They deliver the depth

POD INFRA MILESTONES OWNER

Delivers the depth herself

Owns milestones · Drives outcomes · Sr. SEs for strategic support

GUIDED → AUTONOMOUS

March · April · May · June

SKILLS & EXPERIENCE

Coaching Team

A dedicated coaching team supporting Dilruba's growth across skills, business acumen, and technical excellence.

MANAGER & COACH

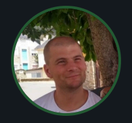
Leandro Lopez
Microsoft Solution Engineering Manager

MANAGER

Paul Verboon
Microsoft Infra Solution Engineer

COACH

CUSTOMER WORK SUPPORT



Marco Cancillo
Microsoft Infra Solution Engineer

CUSTOMER WORK SUPPORT

Bram Boer
Microsoft Infra Solution Engineer

CUSTOMER WORK SUPPORT

TestFlight Team

The panelists joining each TestFlight run across all three sessions to challenge, guide, and evaluate.

RUN 1 — PANELISTS

Eliane
Microsoft Solution Specialist
PANELIST

Emel Mendoza
Microsoft Infra Solution Engineer
PANELIST

USE CASE

Platform Transition Following AVS 36 Retirement

NORTHGRID ENERGY SERVICES

A national power grid provider must migrate off AVS 36 after Microsoft announced end-of-sale. Customers are frustrated and evaluating competitive options. Navigate complex conversations around migration readiness, costs, technical maturity, and long-term platform viability with IT leaders, cloud architects, and financial stakeholders.

RUN 2 — PANELISTS

Aram Smith
Microsoft Infra Solution Engineer
PANELIST

Ivo
Microsoft Solution Specialist
PANELIST

USE CASE

TBD

TBD

Use case to be defined.

APPENDIX

The Three TestFlight Sessions

Your Launchpad to Client Engagements

1

First Client Meeting

Skills and objectives:

- Active listening, asking discovery questions
- Assess current technical estate

2

Business Envisioning

Skills and objectives:

- Explore different solutions
- Clarify business value of solutions
- Synthesize business and technical requirements

3

Solution Envisioning

Skills and objectives:

- Technical deep dive (discussing one solution in depth)
- Address technical objections
- Whiteboarding or technical demonstration

APPENDIX

Certifications

Target certifications for the development plan period

AZ-305
Microsoft

Designing Microsoft Azure Infrastructure Solutions

MICROSOFT CERTIFIED: AZURE SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT EXPERT

- Design identity, governance & monitoring solutions
- Design data storage solutions
- Design business continuity solutions
- Design infrastructure solutions

GH-300
GitHub

GitHub Copilot Certification

GITHUB CERTIFIED

- Use GitHub Copilot responsibly
- Prompt engineering & context crafting
- Improve developer productivity with Copilot
- Configure privacy, exclusions & safeguards

KCNA
CNCF / Linux Foundation

Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate

CNCF CERTIFIED

- Kubernetes fundamentals (44%)
- Container orchestration (28%)
- Cloud native application delivery (16%)
- Cloud native architecture (12%)

PDF

Thank You

Let’s build something great — together.

DILRUBA TURAN · ASPIRE DEVELOPMENT PLAN · 2026